

Read algebraic notation

Foundations

THE IDEA

K, Q, R, B, and N name pieces; a pawn move has no piece letter. The destination is always named. The x marks a capture, + a check, and # a checkmate. Move numbers identify whose turn comes next.

WORKED EXAMPLE

After 1.e4 e5 2.Nf3, White's knight has developed to f3. The notation 2...Nc6 is Black's reply on move two. A move such as exd5 means a pawn from the e-file captures onto d5; it does not specify the starting rank explicitly.

TRY IT BEFORE READING ON

What information does Rxe7+ provide?

ANSWER AND REASONING

A rook captures something on e7 and gives check. The notation alone does not identify the captured piece. Reconstruct the board to learn that and to distinguish between two rooks that might reach e7.

TAKE THIS INTO YOUR NEXT GAME

Translate notation into board changes, not just sounds.